

Locked idea: someone checks your rental flat abroad before you pay

Locked on 4 October 2026. This is the final version of idea #50. It fixes two problems the research found in the first version: the price, and who can legally do the visits.

In one line

Before a student pays a deposit for a flat abroad, a checked local partner visits it, shows it to the family on a live video call, confirms the landlord is the real owner, and sends a report within 48 hours.

What's missing in India today

Indian students going to the UK, Canada, Australia or Germany often pay deposits for flats they have never seen, and rental scams are common. In the UK, the police tell students not to pay until they "or a reliable contact" have visited the flat. A student sitting in India cannot do that alone. Booking sites only check their own student halls. No one visits a private flat the student found by themselves.

How it works

1. The student sends the advert link and address on WhatsApp. You do a free 10-minute "red-flag check" of the advert.
2. If the advert looks real, the family pays. From India, you check whether the photos are copied, who officially owns the flat (£7 record in the UK), its energy rating and licence, and whether the money being asked for is legal.
3. A partner in that city visits with the landlord. The partner shows the family every room on a live video call, matches the landlord's ID with the official owner, and fills in a checklist: damp, heating, safety papers, alarms and transport.
4. Within 48 hours you send a simple report that marks every point green, amber or red. The family decides whether to pay.

Who does the visits (changed)

- **Not current students in the UK.** UK student visa holders are not allowed to be self-employed, so you cannot pay them per visit.
- **In the UK, use** Indian graduates on the post-study (Graduate) visa, British or settled Indians, or the Viewber viewing network as a backup.
- **In Canada,** students may do freelance work within their 24 hours a week off campus. Graduates on a post-study work permit are also fine.
- **In Australia,** sources disagree on whether students may be self-employed. Use graduates or residents until a migration agent confirms.
- **In Germany,** students need permission from the local Foreigners' Office to do freelance work. Use graduates or residents.
- **Everywhere:** check each partner's right to work before their first visit. In the UK this is free online and required from 1 October 2026.

Who pays and how much (changed)

Indian students going abroad, and mostly their parents. UK prices:

- **₹7,999 per flat** outside London (about £63).
- **₹8,999 per flat** in London (about £71).
- **₹12,999 for two flats** in the same city on the same day.
- **₹6,999 for the first 20 customers**, in return for a video review.

Why not ₹3,999? Paying a legal partner, plus the £7 owner record, costs about ₹4,800 per visit outside London. At ₹3,999 you would lose money on every check. At ₹7,999 you keep about ₹1,900 per check, and about 8 checks a month cover your running costs.

Proof it works abroad

- **Propzee (Australia)** inspects rental homes for people who can't view them, such as students and people moving from overseas, for A\$179, with a report within 8 hours.
- **Kinpany (UK)** checks flats for £55 (about ₹7,000), but only in London, and takes 2 to 5 working days.

Who does this now

- **In India:** no one found doing in-person checks. Amber, UniAcco, University Living and Student.com only check their own listings.
- **In the UK:** Kinpany (London only, no live call). Viewber does viewings for landlords and agents, not for students.

Which countries, and when

1. **UK first.** Use the January 2027 intake as a small test. If the mid-February review says go, push hard in June to August 2027 for the September intake.
2. **Canada and Australia next**, once the UK works. Each needs its own rules check before launch.
3. **Germany last.**

To start

- **Money:** about ₹75,000 to set up and ₹1,00,000 to launch. Keep ₹1,00,000 as a reserve you never touch. Release the last ₹25,000 only if the February review says go.
- **Time:** about 3 to 4 weeks to the first paying family.
- **Main risks:** finding reliable, legal partners in every city; Indian student numbers falling (down 16% in the year to June 2026); and two legal questions, for a UK housing lawyer and an Indian CA.

Your next 7 days

1. Register on Udyam (free), get a WhatsApp Business number, and choose a name and Instagram handle.
2. Find 3 to 5 partners in London, Coventry, Leicester, Hatfield and Leeds: Indian graduates on the Graduate visa, or British Indians. Look in Indian student groups (IPLUK, INSA) and LinkedIn alumni groups. Check each partner's right to work.
3. Write the 14-point checklist and the one-page report template.
4. Do 2 to 3 free trial checks for real students, to get reports, testimonials and your first Reels.
5. Book short calls with a UK housing lawyer and an Indian CA, using the questions listed in your business plan.

All money uses £1 = ₹127 (Wise rate, 3 October 2026). The full research and sources are in "UK flat check service plan.pdf".